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Youth and Social Media

It's like in the essay 'the revolution will not be tweeted'. You just click on a button and think you have done your part.'

(Student, Male, Karachi)

Facebook makes you aware of the political parties situation going on and it's just not the reason why I use Facebook. I have to be active on Facebook so that I can contact my siblings who aren't in Pakistan right now.

(Student, Female, Sialkot)

Activism is the next step after awareness. The knowledge you actually have in which you believe.

(Focus Group, Private University[1])

In Pakistan, around 15 to 17.8 per cent of the population is estimated to be internet users, the majority of whom are young Pakistanis (Internet Live Stats 2016; Pew Research Center 2016). The nature of internet access may also be determined by class (see Bolognani 2011). This access is predicted to increase, as mobile companies have started offering internet connectivity packages to their customers, with the aim of reaching Pakistanis across the country (Freedom House 2016). The use of social media sites such as Facebook is popular among the youth (Yusaf 2015). According to Facebook's Audience Insights there are 25 to 30 million active users of Facebook in Pakistan; 22 per cent are women and 78 per cent are men (Facebook Audience Insights 2017).[2] Fifty-seven per cent of these women and 48 per cent of these men are between the ages of eighteen and twenty-four, while 30 per cent and 35 per cent, respectively, are between the ages of twenty-five and thirty-four.[3] The majority of these users are in Lahore (29 per cent) and Karachi (23 per cent). In examining Facebook data, the nexus between mobile companies and Facebook usage is further evident in the number of 'likes'[4] that the page 'Facebook for Every Phone' has received, as it is the most popular site, with 6.1 million people having 'liked' the page.